



Noteable Summer 2026 Environment and UI Updates

Staff & student guidance

Notebook image changes, launch improvements, deep linking and usability enhancements

Academic Year 2026–27

Short announcement for mailing lists or VLE posts

Please feel free to use the text below when communicating with users at your institution

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Subject: Noteable updated for AY 2026/27 testing

Noteable has been updated ahead of Academic Year 2026/27. These updates are now available for users.

This update includes refreshed notebook environments, Codex, Claude and OpenCode coding agents, a clearer launch experience, VS Code in all JupyterLab-based environments, and adds new tools for instructors to support assignment workflows.

Staff are encouraged to test planned teaching materials, notebooks, packages and assessment workflows in Noteable ahead of the start of the academic year.

If you do not have access to the relevant Noteable environment, or are unsure how to access it, please contact your local Learning Technology team. For site representatives, the VLE administrator responsible for the staging environment is the appropriate point of contact to enable access to Noteable Beta for testing.

Notebook environment details are available at:

<https://noteable.edina.ac.uk/notebook-descriptions>

Please report any issues through the Noteable contact form:

<https://noteable.edina.ac.uk/contact-us/>

The Noteable product team appreciates your feedback and testing ahead of the new academic year.

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2. Overview

The Summer 2026 Noteable update includes:

- updated notebook environments;
- clearer launch pages (see details in section 3);
- VLE deep linking to specific notebook servers (see section 4);
- access to AI coding agents
- VS Code available in all JupyterLab-based environments;
- updated Noteable menu options;
- updated assignment workflow tools.

Staff should test planned Academic Year 2026–27 teaching materials, assessment workflows and required packages before the start of semester.

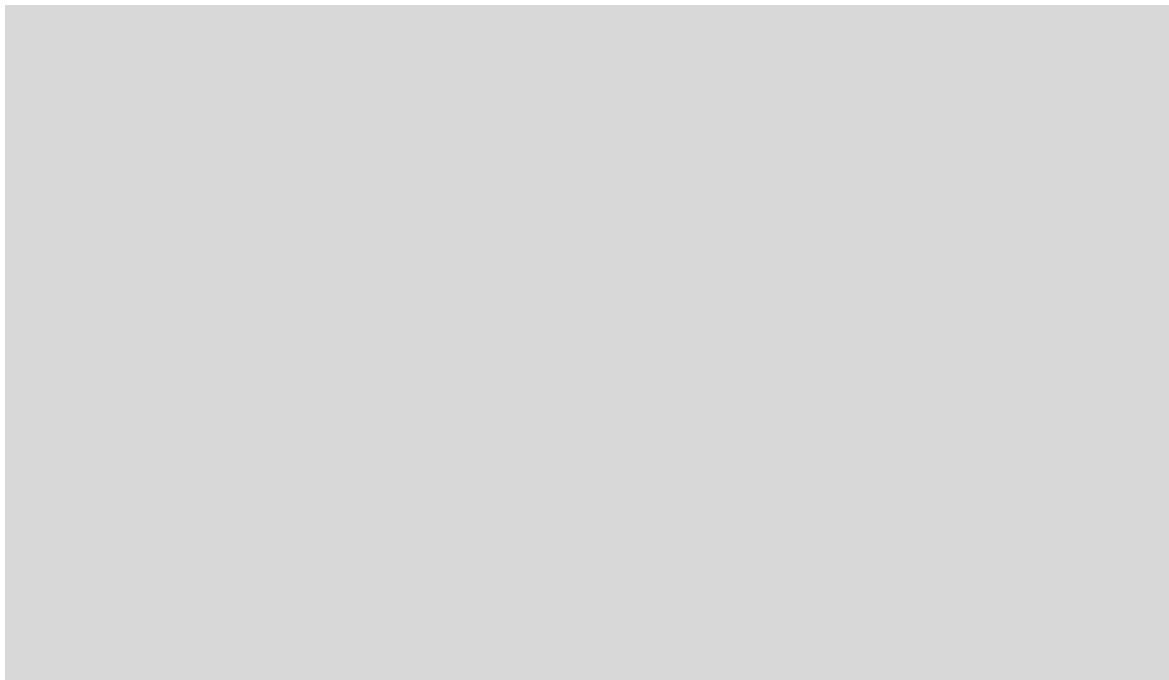
3. Clearer launch experience

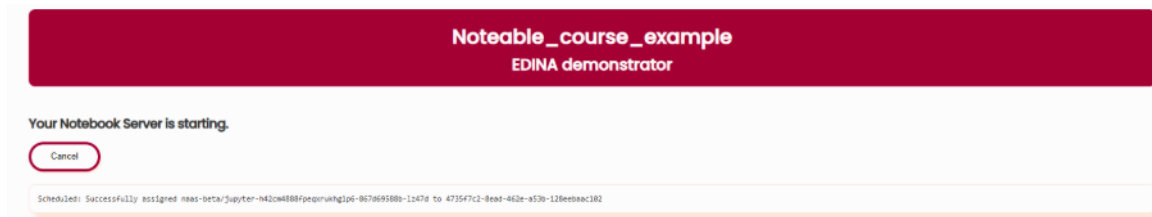
The Noteable launch experience has been updated to make it clearer for staff and students.

The launch process now shows:

- the course code;
- the customer or institution name;
- details of the notebook server startup process.

This should make it easier for users to understand what is happening while their notebook server starts.





Notice the launch process details appear below the Cancel button

4. VLE deep linking to specific notebook servers

Where configured with the institutional VLE, Noteable now supports deep linking to specific notebook server environments. A deep linking course link to Noteable will launch directly into the pre-selected notebook server.

Deep linking must be configured by the VLE administrator before it can be used. Availability of notebook server deep linking depends on the VLE integration and local configuration. Site representatives and course teams should first test the workflow in the relevant staging or beta environment.

Note that

Deep linking allows a course link in the VLE to open a selected Noteable environment directly, such as:

- Standard Python 3;
- RStudio;
- BioChemistry Notebook;
- GeoScience Notebook;
- Language and Machine Learning Notebook;

With deep linking, staff and students can launch directly into the notebook server required for the course without first going through the general Noteable launcher page.

Where appropriate, VLE and course administrators should **ensure that the Noteable LTI tool link is configured to open in a new window/tab**, rather than within the VLE frame. This may need to be enabled when creating or editing an individual deep link, depending on the VLE configuration.

4.1. Recommended deep linking approach

Deep linking is recommended as the default approach for course-level Noteable links where a specific notebook environment is required.

Deep linking helps:

- reduce the risk of students choosing the wrong environment;
- ensures that students switching between different courses using Noteable do so correctly.
- provide a clearer launch process;

- ensure everyone on the course uses the expected notebook server;
- simplify course instructions;
- create a more consistent experience for staff and students.

A generic link to the Noteable launcher page is still possible where users will be allowed to choose their own environment.



Video: Instructor using deep linking to pre-select the notebook server for the LTI course link.

4.2. Important behaviour when using deep links

When a course link is configured as a deep link to a specific notebook server, returning to the Noteable launch page will redirect the user back into the selected notebook environment.

This is expected behaviour.

To switch notebook servers, users should navigate to their institution's course area and use a general course link to the Noteable launcher webpage.

Noteable_course_example

[Course](#) [Settings](#) [Participants](#) [Grades](#) [Reports](#) [More](#) ▾

▼

General

Collapse all

Noteable: BioChemistry Notebook

Announcements

Noteable

Noteable: Standard Python 3

Noteable: Language and Machine Learning

Noteable: BioChemistry Notebook

Noteable: Astronomy Notebook

Noteable: GeoScience Notebook

Navigate to the course page to launch a general course link and switch notebook servers.

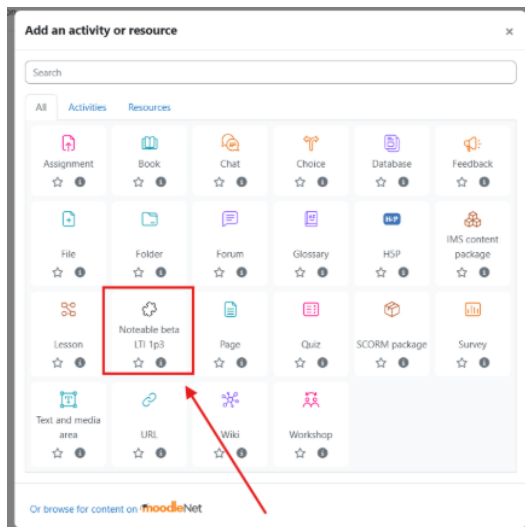
Instructors must set up and select the preferred notebook server for each course link if they want to guarantee that students start in the correct notebook environment.

Note: the Noteable LTI tool link should be configured to open in a new window/tab, rather than within the VLE frame.

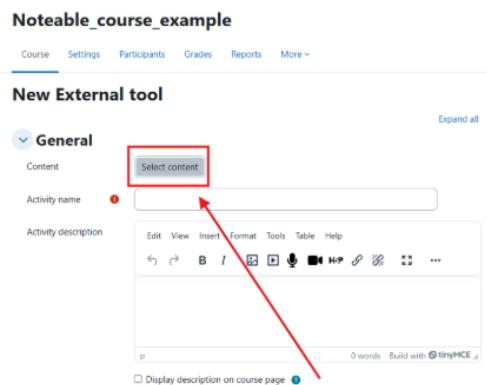
4.3. Setting up a deep link

Please note that the process may vary slightly depending on the VLE and local configuration, and the VLE Admin must first set up the Noteable LTI tool so that instructors can choose it. The general workflow is:

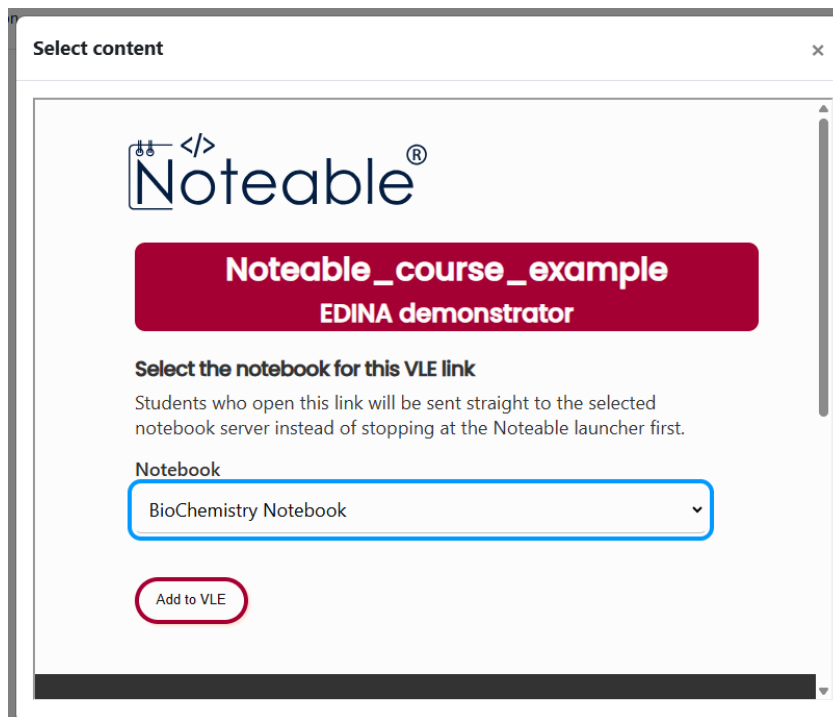
- 4.3.1 Once access to the tool is configured by the VLE admin, add a Noteable link to a course tool as usual.



- 4.3.2 Deep linking adds an option to select content.



- 4.3.3 Select the preferred notebook server for the course link.



- 4.3.4 Confirm the name you would like for the deep link, and save the course LTI link.

New External tool

[Expand all](#)

General

Content Select content ✓ Content selected

Activity name ⓘ Noteable: Introduction to BioChemistry ←

Activity description

Edit View Insert Format Tools Table Help

0 words Build with tinyMCE

☐ Display description on course page ?

- 4.3.5 Return to the course area and test the link.

Noteable_course_example

Bulk actions 

Course Settings Participants Grades Reports More 


General 

Collapse all 


Noteable: Introduction to BioChemistry 



Announcements 


- 4.3.6 Confirm that the selected notebook server opens as expected when using deep linking.



[About Noteable](#)
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Noteable_course_example

EDINA demonstrator

Your Notebook Server is starting.

Cancel

Scheduled: Successfully assigned naas-beta/jupyter-h42c4888fpepruhg1p6-6899cd507f-nxj2w to 4735f7c2-8ead-462e-a53b-128eebaac102

BioChemistry Notebook

The BioChemistry Notebook is a python 3 notebook, with a wide selection of libraries that includes various bio/chemistry libraries.

- Based on the [jupyter/minimal-notebook](#) image, using jupyterlab 4 and Notebook 7 for the User Interface
- Includes [nbgrader](#) and [Jupyterlab-github](#) tools for document sharing.
- A VSCode environment is included, with a collection of extensions for code formatting, linting, and variable inspection.

Read more

To compare the similarities and differences, the [Notebook Descriptions](#) page contains the full list for all available notebook servers.

The course link will launch directly into the selected notebook server.

Availability of notebook server deep linking depends on VLE integration and local configuration and must be configured by the VLE administrator before it can be used. Site representatives and course teams should first test the workflow in the relevant staging or beta environment.

Please contact EDINA if you have issues with deep linking or would like to set it up at your institution.

5. Refreshed notebook environments

Notebook images have been updated with refreshed package versions and environment changes.

Staff should check that:

- teaching notebooks open correctly;
- notebooks run from start to finish;
- required libraries are installed;
- imports work as expected;
- outputs remain valid;

Notebook environment details are available at:

<https://noteable.edina.ac.uk/notebook-descriptions>

6. VS Code in JupyterLab environments

VS Code is now available in all JupyterLab-based environments, directly from the JupyterLab launcher.

This provides a VS Code-style environment for:

- editing code;
- formatting;
- linting;
- working with files;
- developing notebooks;
- managing larger coding projects.



Please note:

- VS Code can run Python .ipynb notebooks.
- VS Code in R with Stan cannot run R in .ipynb files, or R Markdown files.
- RStudio remains the recommended environment for R projects, R scripts and R Markdown workflows.

7. Updated Noteable menu

The Noteable menu now includes:

- a link to Help and Guides;
- a link to service FAQs;
- a button to clear trash permanently.

These changes are intended to make support resources and common housekeeping actions easier to access.

8. Updates to notebooks: Standard Python 3

Standard Python 3 remains the main general-purpose Python notebook environment.

The Summer 2026 update includes:

- VS Code access from the JupyterLab launcher;

- refreshed package versions;

8.1. Specialist subject notebooks

Specialist notebook environments remain available with subject-tailored packages and libraries.

These include:

- Astronomy Notebook;
- BioChemistry Notebook;
- GeoScience Notebook;
- Language and Machine Learning Notebook;
- SageMath

These environments have been refreshed and should be tested with planned Academic Year 2026–27 teaching materials.

Collaboration notebook note

The Collaboration notebook available in the Noteable launcher list may still be subject to a Jupyter duplication issue.

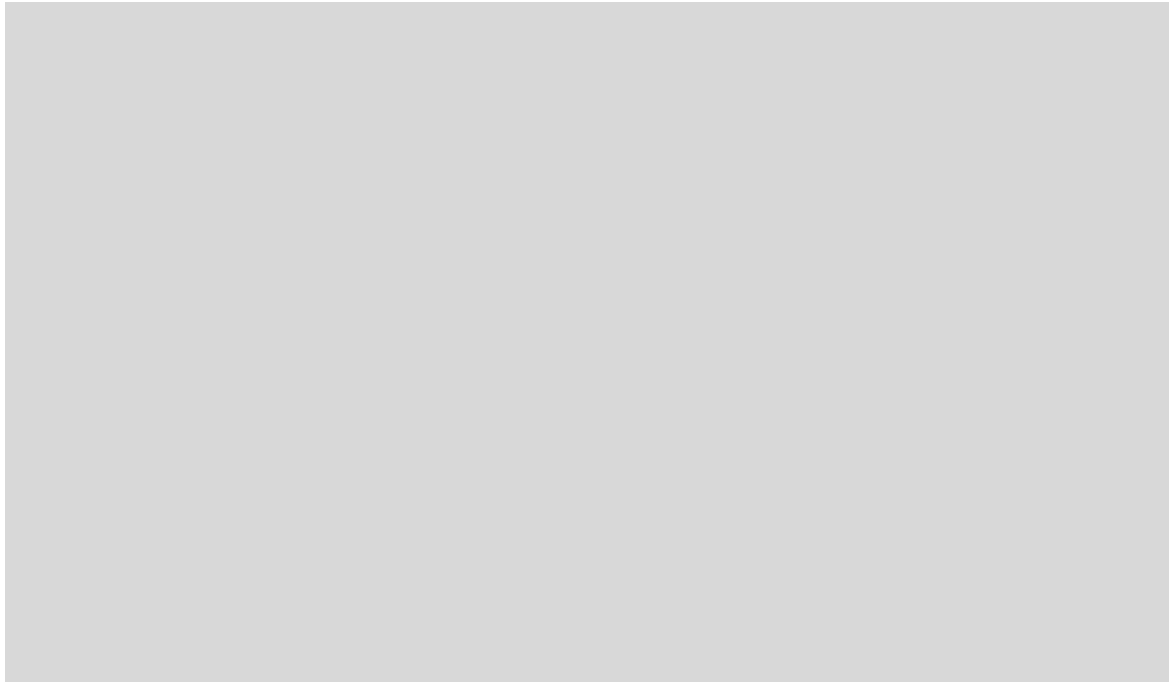
8.2. RStudio

RStudio remains the recommended option for users working with:

- R projects;
- R scripts;
- R Markdown files.

It provides the RStudio IDE and supports R Markdown workflows.

The refreshed RStudio environment includes updated and additional R packages.



8.3. R with Stan

Where R work is required in Jupyter notebook format, users should check whether the R with Stan notebook server meets their needs.

This environment provides an R kernel in JupyterLab.

Important notes:

- R with Stan is suitable where R is needed in a JupyterLab notebook environment.
- VS Code in this environment does not run R-based .ipynb notebooks or R Markdown files.
- Users working with R Markdown should use RStudio.

12. Coding agents

Noteable now provides access to coding agents including:

- Codex;
- Claude;
- OpenCode.

These are available from the command line in Noteable environments.

These tools support AI-assisted coding, debugging, explanation and notebook development workflows.

Noteable provides a safe environment for students to experiment with AI and agentic programming, using sandboxed notebook containers and managed teaching environments.

Coding agents may be updated more frequently than the main notebook images.

For detailed guidance, course teams should refer to the separate Noteable Coding Agents Guidance document.

13. Assignment workflow tools

Noteable also includes updated instructor tools to support assignment management and marking workflows:

- Exchange History;
- Bulk Autograding.

Exchange History allows instructors to review assignment exchange activity, including releases, submissions, collections and feedback activity.

Bulk Autograding allows instructors to collect and autograde submissions more resiliently, reporting failed submissions while continuing to process others where possible.

For full details, course teams should refer to the separate Noteable Assignment Workflow Updates document.

14. Testing course materials for AY 2026–27

Staff are encouraged to test course materials in the updated environments.

We ask you to please review and explore:

- planned notebooks open and run correctly;
- required packages and libraries are present;
- deep links open the correct notebook server;
- teaching materials produce expected results;
- Explore Exchange History;
- Explore Bulk Autograding;

15. Reporting feedback

When reporting an issue, please include:

- your university username;
- the notebook environment used and the course or test area used to access Noteable;
- the notebook or package affected;
- steps to reproduce the issue;
- screenshots or error messages;
- Expected and actual behaviour;
- Please send feedback through the Noteable website contact form so that a support ticket can be created:

<https://noteable.edina.ac.uk/contact-us/>

Thank you for helping test and confirm that the updated environments are ready for teaching.